



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Liberty Christian Classical School
School Website: <https://www.libertychristianmi.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Liberty Christian Classical School (Baroda, MI, 49106) presents a strongly classical, Christian education model focused on formation, virtue, and a biblically integrated liberal-arts program. Public-facing materials emphasize a Christ-centered worldview, Biblical truth, and a partnership with parents, together with a traditional classical curriculum that includes Latin and a scaled, grammar–logic–rhetoric orientation in spirit, supported by Hillsdale College's K-12 curriculum framework. Evidence across the site highlights religious foundations (biblical truth, theology, worship leanings), a formation-focused purpose (virtue, wisdom, service), and a community orientation (parent partnership, ongoing communications). Some elements essential to a fuller classical pedagogy—explicit adoption of Great Books/Great Conversation, and explicit Socratic/seminar-style pedagogy in upper grades—are present in limited public-facing language, resulting in a nuanced profile with a mix of strong classical alignment and some inconspicuous gaps.

Overall classification by category - Element 1 — Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL - Element 2 — School Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL - Element 3 — Curriculum: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 4 — Pedagogy or Teaching Methods: NOT CLASSICAL - Element 5 — Faculty: CLASSICAL - Element 6 — Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

Aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL

Most important insights - The school grounds its mission in Biblical truth and a Christ-centered, biblically integrated approach across disciplines, aligning with transcendental moral realism and theology foundations found in classical criteria. Evidence includes explicit statements about Biblical truth, theology integration, and worship-oriented or spiritually formative activities. - The curriculum identifies classical liberal arts orientation (grammar/logic/rhetoric language of classical education) and Latin study, alongside a history- and literature-rich program; however, explicit articulation of Great Books, Great Conversation, and the full Seven Liberal Arts in public-facing materials is less explicit. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Curriculum. - Pedagogy evidence highlights contemplative and formation-oriented aims, but explicit, documented Socratic seminars, debates, and high-school rhetoric projects are not clearly described in public materials, which explains a NOT CLASSICAL assessment for Pedagogy. - Faculty and leadership imagery is strong: Founding Members and a visible focus on teachers as mentors living the curriculum, with statements about teacher profiles and professional leadership, supporting CLASSICAL alignment. - Parents & Community are positioned as partners and co-educators, with explicit language about parental authority in education, and invitations for visits and involvement, reinforcing CLASSICAL alignment.

What would move the needle - For Curriculum: prominently publish or articulate Great Books/Great Conversation commitments and explicit grammar–logic–rhetoric progression, including canonical authors or works, to shift from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL toward CLASSICAL. - For Pedagogy: publish explicit examples of Socratic seminars, debates, or public-speaking opportunities in upper grades, along with a stated plan for rhetoric training and assessment to move Pedagogy to CLASSICAL. - For all areas: include more explicit,

public-facing statements about the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) in the curriculum map, and connect daily practice to Wonder-based, liturgical, or contemplative pedagogy as part of a cohesive, openly articulated “scholé-like” rhythm.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school describes a Christian, Bible-based worldview and a Christ-centered approach to education, with explicit references to Biblical truth and theology integrated into teaching and student formation. This is evident in mission statements and policy language found in admissions and about pages, as well as in job descriptions that emphasize spiritual leadership and ministerial duties.
- Liturgical or communal practices appear as part of the educational culture (worship opportunities and spiritual leadership in programming), consistent with liturgical/community dimensions.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: biblical truth, theology, biblical worldview, Christ-centered, worship, ministerial, spiritual leadership.
- Negative keywords present: none detected in public materials.
- Presence: multiple explicit terms align with transcendental morality and theological grounding.
- Why this rating
- The weight of explicit biblical/theological language and Christ-centered framing strongly supports a CLASSICAL classification for foundational religious and metaphysical orientation. The materials foreground transcendental moral realism (truth, virtue, beauty) through a biblically integrated framework.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The mission emphasizes forming virtue and wisdom, virtuous living, critical thinking, service to others, and lifelong love of learning, not solely job preparation. This formation-focused aim aligns with the classical purpose emphasis on human excellence and moral cultivation.
- The school positions education as formation rather than information and emphasizes human flourishing, virtue, and wisdom as central aims. The language about virtue, wisdom, and the pursuit of excellence is recurrent.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: virtue, wisdom, formation, goodness, truth, beauty, human excellence, moral development, service, lifelong love of learning.
- Negative keywords present: none directly (no explicit emphasis on job-prep or career outcomes in public-facing mission statements).
- Presence: Strong positive signal across mission and formation language.
- Why this rating
- The explicit articulation of formation, virtue, wisdom, and a non-job-oriented educational telos supports CLASSICAL in this category. The emphasis on truth, goodness, and beauty as real aligns with classical metaphysical aims.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The Academic Program states a traditional, classical liberal arts education, including phonics and cursive in younger grades, Latin in grades 3–12, and a broad distribution of history, literature, mathematics, science, fine arts, and physical education across grade levels. This confirms a classical curricular frame and the inclusion of several core liberal-arts elements.

- The school's Hillsdale College K-12 Curriculum affiliation and the emphasis on a traditional liberal-arts structure further anchor the classical curricular orientation.
- The site repeatedly emphasizes "Pursue the Good, the True, and the Beautiful" and the aim to acquire wisdom and virtue, consistent with classical aims for a curriculum that integrates moral philosophy and aesthetics.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: classical liberal arts, Latin, history, literature, mathematics, science, phonics, cursive, integrated curriculum, Great Books/Great Conversation language is less explicit (public pages emphasize "great artists" rather than canonical Great Books), wonder and beauty, moral philosophy, sacred order.
- Negative keywords present: explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language is not consistently visible on public-facing pages; no strong emphasis on seven liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as explicit cataloged prerequisites in the curriculum map published on the site.
- Presence: Moderate positive signal; core liberal-arts elements appear, but explicit Great Books/Seven Liberal Arts articulation and explicit Socratic dialogue are not clearly stated in public-facing materials.
- Why this rating
- The curriculum clearly reflects classical structure through liberal-arts framing and Latin/historic-literary emphasis, but the public articulation of the full suite of classic elements (notably explicit Great Books, Great Conversation, and the explicit grammar/logic/rhetoric triad) is not consistently published. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL in Curriculum.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public-facing materials lack explicit, detailed evidence of Socratic seminars, high-school-level rhetoric instruction, or a formal program of seminars/debates that characterizes a classical pedagogy in upper grades. The available pages emphasize formation, wonder, and a traditional curriculum but do not clearly spell out Socratic pedagogy as a recurring method in Grades 9–12.
- The lower- to middle-grade pedagogy language focuses on wonder, memorization, and general contemplative aims, but does not provide explicit evidence of the full Socratic/seminar model per grade level. The Art Teacher job description emphasizes curriculum delivery within a classical framework rather than a Socratic seminar approach.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: contemplation, wonder, reverence, sacred, holistic formation, memory, memorization, classical framework; though not all are used as formal pedagogy descriptors.
- Negative keywords present: explicit Socratic dialogue, seminars, debates, and high-school rhetoric instruction are not publicly documented as standard pedagogy across grades.
- Presence: Mixed signals; formation and contemplative aims exist, but the hallmark classical pedagogy (Socratic method, seminars, debates, rhetoric training) is not clearly documented in public materials.
- Why this rating
- While the school presents a formation-based, classical-friendly orientation, the absence of clearly articulated Socratic pedagogy and deliberate upper-level discourse practices on public-facing materials justifies a NOT CLASSICAL designation for Pedagogy at this time. The gap suggests potential for future alignment through explicit pedagogy statements and practice.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school highlights founding members and a close-knit leadership/teacher community; Founding Members are described with roles and leadership responsibilities, signaling a living, virtuous leadership culture. The faculty are framed as the living curriculum and core of the school through statements about teacher roles, mentorship, and collaboration.
- Job descriptions and recruitment language emphasize high standards, ministerial/spiritual leadership, and collaboration with parents, indicating a faculty culture oriented toward virtue, knowledge, and

collegiality. The Art Teacher job description emphasizes classical education alignment and ministerial leadership responsibilities.

- The school's materials also present a framework of teachers as mentors and the school as a collaborative community in which faculty shape culture and practice.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, core of the school, profile of a teacher, collaborative team, spiritual leadership in staff.
- Negative keywords present: none evident in public-facing materials.
- Presence: Strong presence of classical-faculty indicators (mentorship, living curriculum, and core-teacher leadership imagery).
- Why this rating
- The combination of Founding Members, explicit teacher-centered language, and a clearly defined teacher profile supports a CLASSICAL classification for Faculty. The materials portray teachers as virtuous, knowledgeable, and central to the school's mission and culture.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school explicitly frames parents as partners and co-teachers in the educational project, rather than replace them; it emphasizes parental authority and collaboration, aligned with classical education philosophy. This is visible in admissions language, mission statements, and site content that invites parental involvement and ongoing engagement.
- There are multiple references to partnering with parents, inviting shadow days, visits, inquiries, and community involvement, indicating a strong parental-engagement posture.
- Materials also describe education as a shared mission with families, and emphasize that parents are educated and welcomed to participate in the school community.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: parents as co-teachers, partnership with parents, parental involvement, welcoming parents, education in partnership with families.
- Negative keywords present: none evident in public materials.
- Presence: Clear and continuous emphasis on parent partnership and community engagement.
- Why this rating
- The school consistently frames parents as integral to the educational process and invites them into the learning community, which aligns strongly with CLASSICAL expectations for parent-community collaboration.

What Would Move the Needle

- Curriculum (Element 3): Publicly articulate and publish a formal Great Books/Great Conversation component and a transparent Seven Liberal Arts map (grammar, logic, rhetoric) with grade-level progression. This would elevate Curriculum from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL by making explicit the canonical liberal-arts framework and Great-Books orientation.
- Concrete steps: publish a curriculum overview document that lists core Great Books, authors, and conversation goals; outline explicit grammar–logic–rhetoric progressions across K–12; include sample units showing integration of humanities, philosophy, and theology in a coherent classical sequence.
- Pedagogy (Element 4): Introduce explicit, public-facing statements and examples of Socratic or seminar-based pedagogy in upper grades, with opportunities for student rhetoric and public speaking, to move pedagogy toward CLASSICAL.
- Concrete steps: implement a formal description of Socratic seminars, debates, and persuasive speaking assignments in high school, with sample rubrics; provide teacher professional development in classical pedagogy and a schedule showing seminars integrated into the academic calendar.
- All other categories (1, 2, 5, 6) already demonstrate strong CLASSICAL alignment; maintain and

expand communications that inventory the evidence (e.g., more explicit theology integration across disciplines, more detailed faculty profiles, and ongoing parent education resources) to further reinforce CLASSICAL positioning publicly.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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